

SURREY SCOUT

JULY/AUGUST, 1979

No. 386

County Chairman

Since writing in the April issue I have attended a number of very interesting District Annual General Meetings and having in the past been critical of the standards of such meetings I would like to say that those in which I participated this year made me feel that standards were very much improved. Some were quite excellent in every respect and all were efficient and enjoyable. I congratulate the District Officials who organised them and the Council members and supporters who participated.

Having achieved an improved presentation, may I suggest an aim for next year? Namely that special steps be taken to increase the participation of Mums and Dads and indeed of the public at large. Attracting the attendance of people not directly involved in running Scouting should not be too difficult though it would be counter-productive if the A.G.M. were not both efficient and interesting. So, hopefully we can sustain the standard and widen the audience.

We still have great need to make known what we are doing as widely as possible even though we may sometimes feel that the media pay us less attention than we think is deserved. One explanation of this, which I offered at those A.G.M.s where I was asked to speak, is the quite staggering number of the inhabitants of Surrey who are actively involved, in one form or another, in a caring voluntary service. Small wonder the local press finds difficulty in fitting in as much reference to Scouting as we might like.

However I remain convinced that wider audiences at public functions such as A.G.M.s where we can present our stories of achievement are an essential part of the provision of social atmosphere in which

success breeds success.

While visiting District A.G.M.s I took the opportunity of discussing informally with District Secretaries, Treasurers and Chairmen the matter of a two-day course. Those concerned may recall that the proposal was discussed at our District Officials Conference on February 4th. I am sure we should now go ahead with our plans for such a course for District Officials in the early Autumn of 1980 and the County Secretary and I will be discussing the matter with the A.C.C. (Leader Training) during the next few weeks.

Meanwhile, I have gained the impression that it is widely felt that a District Officials' Conference should again be held in February 1980. I would be most interested to hear from any District Chairman, Secretary, Treasurer or P.R.O. who has views to offer on these two proposals. Perhaps at the February Conference we might discuss, inter alia, methods of attracting parents and the public to the A.G.M.s.

Of potentially wider interest to Scouting in Surrey (and perhaps beyond) is the President's Strategy Group. In April I reported that it had held two meetings and it will be of interest to know that a paper is now in preparation following those discussions. This paper will provide the basis for further study on features specifically identified as having major significance. The Group meets again in September to examine the propositions in the paper and I feel you would wish to join me in wishing Mr. Jim Wilson and all the members of the Group success in their efforts and in sending our sincere thanks to these very busy people for giving so generously of their time.

W. GEOFFREY WRIGHT

County Commissioner

"Scout programmes are by their very nature practical and involve activity in the widest sense. For all activities and games there is a requirement for common sense and responsibility. Where activities involve going away from home or are of an adventurous nature, thus providing an element of risk, it is necessary to provide rules".

This extract from the Policy, Organisation and Rules of The Scout Association ("P.O.R.") introduces a section on Activity Rules. The 1979 edition of P.O.R. includes many new and helpful guidelines on all aspects of safety and should be compulsory reading for all Leaders taking, or authorising, adventurous activities at any time - but especially in relation to Summer camps and expeditions.

With so many Scout Shops in Districts around Surrey these days, there is absolutely no excuse for Groups not to have at least one copy of P.O.R. Parts I and II. Ideally every Section Leader should have a personal copy of Part II covering all aspects of training.

The 1979 edition is very comprehensive. Activity Rules in Part II cover the following:-

Rule 72.

Activities in the air: Flying and gliding, hang gliding (not an approved activity), parachuting and parascending.

Rule 73.

Camping and expeditions: This also covers Cub Scout holidays and overseas visits.

Rule 74.

Activities on land: Caving, activities on moors, hills and mountains, rock climbing and skiing.

Rule 75.

Activities on the water: The whole subject of Boat Certificates and Charge Certificates is, for the first time I do believe, set out very clearly. Whether the activity is canoeing (more popular than ever these days), rowing, sailing, cruising or using power boats, it is absolutely mandatory that Leaders are aware of the requirements for Charge and Boat Certificates and when buoyancy aids or life

jackets must be worn. Even rafting is covered together with sub-aqua, water skiing and, by no means least, swimming.

Rule 76.

Other activities and pursuits: These include the use of aerial runways, archery, martial arts (!) riding and shooting.

There is also a special section on rules for joint activities with members of our sister Movement.

In most cases the safety rules laid down by the National Association for the activity concerned are those which apply when that activity is pursued in the course of Scouting. The demand for a wide range of activities during the course of Summer camps and expeditions is such that everyone involved must be fully aware of the standards required. Furthermore everyone should be aware of Rule 71 (vi) which states significantly: "Non-compliance with these Activity Rules can adversely affect a Member's insurance cover". Please take note!

In the July/August Edition of "Surrey Scout" last year, I drew attention for the need to ensure that all Group transport must be properly maintained. This may be expensive but if a Group or Unit can raise the money to buy the vehicle in the first place, it has a responsibility to ensure that further funds are available to keep it in good condition. With a bus load of young people, transmission, steering and braking systems in particular must be in A1 condition at all times. Nothing less is acceptable.

Having drawn attention to this vital subject of safety, I hope that observance of the stipulated standards will enable everyone to have a really enjoyable and adventurous, but safe, Summer camp or expedition.

A final extract from P.O.R. sums it all up nicely:

"All activities involve risk, but with good training, proper equipment and responsible leadership, these risks can be minimised to provide adventure and fun for all Members of the Movement"

GORDON BATES

Leader Training

There is no time to spare if you are one of those Leaders who intended taking an Advanced course this year and hasn't done anything about it. Course dates are set out below and there is already a healthy demand for places so contact the appropriate course Leader and reserve a place before it is too late. Pack Holiday courses at Bentley Copse have been popular again and in the autumn a Camp Fire Leaders course is being offered.

Reluctantly we must face the fact that autumn will be upon us all too soon, but as a compensation for those who need a Basic course these will be around the County for the following 8 months. Dates of the first ones are set out below and more will be published in the September issue, in the meantime contact your A.D.C. (L.T.) if you want some guidance on the subject of where and when you are best placed to find the training you need.

DAVID BARRELL

Courses

General Information Courses

Mitcham 22nd July
Woking 7th October
Surrey 7th October

Camp Fire Leader Course

Bentley Copse 6th/7th October

Basic Courses

SCOUT LEADERS

Woking
Croydon

Advanced Courses

CUB SCOUT LEADERS

(non-residential)
SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse

VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

Bentley Copse 22nd/23rd September and
20th/21st October

GROUP SCOUT LEADERS & COMMISSIONERS

13th/14th October
and 2nd December

Miss M. Pooley 71 Beech Grove, Mitcham.
Mrs. D. Martin, 103 Lovelace Drive, Pyrford
D. Whiteman, 17 May Close, Chessington.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.
H. Smith, 266 Whitehorse Lane, S.E.25.

E.W. Daniel, Flat 7, Barfield Court, Ladbroke Road,
Redhill.

D.W. Barker, 3, Oriental Close, Woking.

B.C. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

D.R. Barrell, 1, Beech Road, Reigate.

(during these courses the whole of the Wood Badge will be completed as an integral part, details will be given to applicants by the appropriate Course Leaders).

Cub Scouts

I sit down to write this contribution for "Surrey Scout" having just returned from a week on a camp-site near Middleton-on-Sea, Sussex, with friends and their families all of whom are involved in Scouting, plus a crazy P.L. from the Mickleham Scout Troop. The weather was varied, plenty of rain, a thunder-storm, a couple of gales and a minute glimpse of the sun. However, we all had a good time despite our

problems with inclement weather. All of this reminds me of the friendship we enjoy in Scouting, even under difficult circumstances and especially of the next two months when most camps and pack holidays will be taking place. May I take this opportunity to wish you every success with your camps and pack holidays and an enjoyable and restful personal holiday with good weather for everyone.

STEVE HALL

Cub Country

I am very fortunate to know a Doctor who is working in Nepal at the moment. Much of her work is devoted to caring for the children and, as she has sent home two wonderfully detailed 'circular' letters, I thought some extracts might be of interest to readers of 'Surrey Scout'.

She went last September with much courage and a little apprehension to work at the United Mission to Nepal Hospital at Tansen. This is situated between Pokhara and Butwal, both of which are clearly marked on the Cub Country map, and Tansen is a fourteen hour bus ride from Kathmandu.

In her first letter she describes the journey out: "My flights were good, with little difficulty despite excess baggage (much needed medical supplies). I made friends with passengers and enjoyed looking down at the scenery and fluffy clouds like cotton wool or icing sugar. The weather was glorious. I thought of everyone at home. After many anxieties, I felt filled with joy and expectation as I flew into Nepal. I should have trusted more and not been worried. The country is beautiful with mountains and windy paths (rather reminiscent of my Swiss workcamp surroundings), maize and terraces of rice. Homes are poor, often open to the mud paths. It's so warm; windows need no glass but have mosquito netting at windows and doors. Clothes are like dirty rags, and, if not barefoot, the flipflops look as if they should have been ditched years ago. Flies are common because of primitive sanitation and often settle on the people, even in Hospital. The people are strong and carry vast loads; they earn livings from selling produce.

We went to church this morning in a room at the top of a house. We sat barefoot on the floor, women on one side, men the other. We're allowed to be Christian but not to convert. We were strengthened by some Nepalis who have recently had encounters with the law which forbids conversion. We sang "How great Thou art" in Nepali.

People here are kind and I have been made very welcome. I hope to get out to see some of the Village Clinics. There's a lot of work going on to teach local girls and young men the elements of nursing, mid-wifery and medicine so that they can be used in

Village Clinics, especially in mother and baby care. There's so much to do.

Families are large though many children die, and it is very important to have a son whose wife will look after parents in their old age. Illness is severe and facilities limited. I am happy to be here and already feel I may be useful, especially in Paediatrics. I am grateful that I am not in India where it is hotter and more crowded, nor in South Africa facing political problems. There is much beauty here and conditions for me are much more comfortable than I had anticipated. Post may not be reliable, especially postcards and foreign stamps, but air letter forms travel well. However I am very well provided for here and am so glad to be able to share a little of my experience with you."

In a letter sent to me, in response to my enquiry for general information regarding 'Cub Country', Dr. Muddiman wrote:-

"I have a booklet produced in Nepal by the Scouts, etc., about the International Year of the Child, and am delighted to hear that your Cub Scouts are involved too. I enclose a booklet which may help the Scouts get an idea of the sort of work we do here. The two areas in which the Cub Scouts will be helping are tremendously important. The people here need to learn so much about nutrition, and many places are so remote. Please do thank the Cub Scouts for all that they are doing for the children of Nepal."

In another letter (from which I could perhaps quote at greater length on another occasion if invited by the Editor!). Dr. Muddiman mentions that a B.B.C. camera crew were in Tansen, filming for a programme in "The World About Us" series to be shown on B.B.C.2 on a Sunday evening in June or July. It is possible we shall see some of her patients - possibly Rebecca (Nepali) looking into a little one's ear (note the red hair and big tummy of malnutrition), hear about an outpatient who'd caught her finger in a rice mill and see part of Dr. Muddiman's Ward Round. She has adopted native dress and adds that she hopes her Nepali saree and cholo (blouse) won't be totally hidden by her white coat!

SHEILA SANDFORD

Water Activities

Classification of the Thames for Charge Certificates

The Headquarter Commissioner for Water Activities has now ruled that the Thames between Wraybury and Richmond House lock should be classified B1, for all water activities. From now on it is, therefore, essential for all groups who operate on the Thames to recognise that boys and leaders need to hold a Charge Certificate to a B1 grade before they can go on the water alone or in command, unless they are under instruction. Alternatively they must have the autho-

riety of somebody who holds an Instructor Charge Certificate. There will be opportunities for leaders and Venture Scouts over 18 years of age to obtain endorsements on their Charge Certificates "Authorised to Supervise". These will be obtainable after attending a Leadership and Supervisory Skills Course. These courses will be run by the A.C.C. (Leader Training) with the assistance of the Water Activities Committee, hopefully starting this year.

JOHN FORBAT

Scouts

July 13th/15th will see the culmination of many months of preparation for "SCOUTOUT 79". If you receive your copy of "Surrey Scout" early in July (as I hope is the case) then the preparations of many Scout Troops in Surrey should be all but complete. Before tracks are made in the direction of Rushmoor Arena, I certainly hope the opportunity is going to be taken to try out new skills and activities, to meet Scouts and Guides from other parts of the County, to exchange ideas, and of course to have lots of fun and enjoyment. Here's hoping the weather will be kind to us on this occasion!

SCOUTOUT is obviously not the only major event which must be in the minds of Scout Troops in Surrey at this time of year. The Summer Camp is very near and again preparations should be well under way - dare I suggest that they should all be complete at this stage? It is often said that the Scouting year's programmes/activities lead logically through to the great experience of Summer Camp. Certainly the Patrol Leaders' Council - if it is doing its proper job - will have planned the Summer Camp programme in

some detail, ensuring that there is a good balance between activities and the teaching of new skills to our Scouts at whatever stage they have reached, and making sure that the camp is a credit to the Troop and to Scouting.

In thinking about Summer Camps, can I put in a particular plea for the very young Scouts to receive especial consideration. Please make sure that they really enjoy their first experience of Troop camping, and that they are encouraged to achieve the highest standards possible. This means that a good example must be set at all times by leaders, both boy and adult. First impressions do stick!

I wish all Troops in the County successful and enjoyable camping during the Summer period. Best wishes also to the Scout Section members of our Jamboree contingent. They have a great and unique experience ahead of them. After the event I hope that Districts and Groups will ask our Jamboree representatives to recount their experiences as wide as possible.

JIM ELLIOT

SEE YOU AT

SCOUTOUT 79

JULY 13/15th

Congratulations

County Diary

MEDAL OF MERIT

P.H. Brunswick
The Right Hon.
Sir David Cairns, P.C.
B.R. Fairchild
D. Farnes
Mrs. N.K. Farnes
A.A.G. Jeffery
G.P. Mapley
J. Martin
E.J. Quickenden
Mrs. G.R. Quickenden
Mrs. M.C. Shipman

S.L. 1st Fetcham
President, Leatherhead
A.D.C. (C.S.). Horley
G.S.L. 10th Horley
C.S.L. 10th Horley
G.S.L. 1st Brookwood
District Shop Manager, Woking
Chairman Surrey Heath
A.C.S.L. 7th Horley
C.S.L. 7th Horley
Secretary Surrey Heath

CHIEF SCOUT'S COMMENDATION FOR GOOD SERVICES

R. Barrow
A.F. Gould

Badge Secretary Surrey Heath
Group Lay Member,
1st Cranleigh

W.S. Smith

Group Treasurer 9th Horley

CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Ian Barnett
Alistair Brien
David Cannon
Kevin Champion
Anthony Choules
Peter Cook
Russell Cooper

St. Saviours, Guildford
Holy Trinity, Guildford
1st Woodmansterne
1st Nork
1st Shepperton, St. Nicholas
4th Ewell

Graham Edmendes
Paul Eustace
Michael Green
Kevin Harris
Vincent Kilner
David Knight
Michael Mallon
Roger Norrington
Keith Sherry

3rd Farnham
1st Shepperton, St. Nicholas
3rd Ashford
4th Walton
1st Stoughton
1st Englefield Green
4th Ewell
2nd New Haw
1st Normandy
7th Farnham
1st Stoughton
3rd Farnham
9th Horley
2nd New Haw
1st Cranleigh
11th Farnham
2nd New Haw
2nd New Haw
2nd New Haw
1st Fetcham
1st Fetcham

Jonathan Taylor
Mark Tennyson
Adrian Whinney
Keith Wilson
Richard Forsyth
Roy Goldsmith
Christopher Goddard
Michael Normington
Adrian Oldfield
John Plummer
Andrew Street
Andrew Woodland

July

2 Scout Sub-Committee
6/8 National Scout Regatta
8 Venture Scout First Aid
Competition

Holme Pierrepont

Rushmore Arena
B.P. House

13/15 Scoutout '79

18 County Executive Committee

September

11 County Finance Sub-Committee
13 Water Activities Sub-Committee
14 Scout Association A.G.M.
20 Venture Scout Sub-Committee
22/23 Longridge Regatta
26 Fellowship Sub-Committee
29/30 Scout Patrol & Camping
Competition

"A"

B-P House
Dorking
Longridge

Bentley Copse

October

1 Scout Sub-Committee
2 Cub Scout Sub-Committee
13 Chief Scout's Award Presentation
14 Rifle Club Annual Shoot
17 County Executive Committee

Leatherhead
Leatherhead

Farnham
Bisley

B.P. House

November

10 County Swimming Gala

Guildford

December

4 Water Activities Sub-Committee
6 Venture Scout Sub-Committee
11 County Finance Sub-Committee

Cuddington
Dorking

September "Surrey Scout"

Copy Date

10th August

26th August

Distribution

Please Note

There will be no issue of "Surrey Scout" nor
County Distribution at the end of July for 1st August.